

**SOLVING THE OMNI
CHALLENGE:
HOW BRANDS CAN WIN IN
AN AI-DRIVEN, FRAGMENTED
COMMERCE WORLD**

Learn how you can win by unifying fragmented customer journeys, leveraging AI-driven tools and delivering seamless and personalized experiences across every commerce touchpoint.

NIQ Brandbank

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01

THE OMNI CHALLENGE HAS ARRIVED

Today's marketplace has never been more complex, or more full of opportunity. Over the past decade, retail has shifted from predictable, channel focused journeys to a constantly evolving ecosystem where shoppers move fluidly across all channels, utilizing AI-powered assistants. The digital shelf is no longer a single destination. It is an interconnected, always on network shaped by algorithms, content quality and consumer expectations that change in real time.

The reality is that brands must operate in an AI-driven, fragmented commerce world where visibility is earned, but not guaranteed. Today's shoppers expect instant clarity, complete transparency and consistent product information across all channels, wherever they encounter the brand. All it takes is one missing image, one mismatched detail, one outdated attribute that can create consequences from abandoned baskets to long term damage in trust.

Simultaneously, retailers are expanding and tightening their content expectations, each creating their own standard and specifications. Social platforms are launching new commerce tools at pace and marketplaces are elevating accuracy and completeness standards. Then there is AI. AI is reshaping everything from how products are discovered and compared to how information is generated, interpreted and ranked.

Fragmentation isn't slowing down, it is accelerating.

This is the omni challenge:

The urgent need for brands to manage, optimize and activate complete product content everywhere commerce happens. All at the speed that today's shoppers expect and the precision that AI algorithms demand.

For many, this is where the challenge becomes overwhelming. Manual processes, scattered data sources and inconsistent content makes it nearly impossible to deliver a unified product story across the expanding digital shelf.

02

WHY PRODUCT CONTENT IS THE NEW BATTLEFIELD

In a world where shoppers have limitless choice and instant access to information, product content has become one of the most powerful differentiators a brand can control. Product content is the foundation of how visibility is earned, trust is built and decisions are made across the entire digital ecosystem.

For many shoppers, the product experience begins long before they ever touch the item or even visit a retailer's website. The first moment has shifted to search results, comparison tools, social feeds and AI-generated summaries. In these environments, content is the product. Titles, product descriptions, attributes, images, claims, ingredients and rich media all shape how a product is perceived. When content is complete, compelling and consistent, it acts as a silent salesperson, communicating value, answering shopper questions and building confidence and trust. When it is not, the shopper simply moves on.

Every channel judges content differently. Algorithms now determine what shoppers see.

Unlike traditional in-store retail where packaging and shelf position were standardized, digital channels each have their own unique expectations:

- Search platforms prioritize clarity and structured data
- Marketplaces reward detail, accuracy and compliance
- Retailers require specific attributes to power filters, comparisons and search
- Social commerce thrives on visual storytelling and digestible product information
- AI assistants depend on structured, machine-readable data to interpret and present a product meaningfully

This creates a competitive environment where winning requires not just having content but optimizing it for every shelf a product appears on.

Content is the backbone of the modern shopper experience. From discovery to decision to purchase, every step of the shopper journey is shaped by the quality, accuracy and consistency of the product content. Trust is fragile and product content is one of the first places it is either won or lost. This is why leading brands are treating product content as a core enabler of growth.

03

EQUIP FOR VICTORY: ESTABLISHING A UNIFIED SOURCE OF PRODUCT TRUTH

To compete in an AI-driven, omnichannel environment, the most important strategic advantage a brand can build is a single, reliable, consistently governed source of product truth. It is the foundation to mastering the omni challenge.

A single source of truth transforms chaos into clarity.

When all product content lives in a single, governed environment, brands eliminate the discrepancies that commonly appear across channels. Titles match. Attributes align. Claims remain compliant. Imagery is consistent. Every update cascades across the ecosystem.

Shoppers get the same story wherever they engage, and consistent stories build trust.

Without a single source of truth, making updates to react to market changes, product formulations, regulation changes, updates are manual and time consuming, leaving gaps that not only affect sales but also compliance. With a single source of truth, brands can update once and syndication everywhere, reducing risk and accelerating speed to shelf.

It also drives a stronger cross-functional alignment. Product teams, marketing teams, ecommerce teams, regulatory teams, sales teams – all rely on product content yet often work from different datasets or versions of the truth. One source of the truth aligns the entire organization around the same accurate, up to date information, eliminating internal friction and enabling improved decision making.

A single source of truth doesn't just solve today's challenges, it prepares brands for every new channel, platform, and AI innovation still to come.

04

SOLVING THE OMNI CHALLENGE: THE NIQ BRANDBANK FRAMEWORK

The omni challenge isn't just about managing complexity, it is about turning the complexity into a competitive advantage. It is ultimately about meeting human expectations in a digital environment that is expanding faster than more brands can keep up with.

The building blocks that directly shape both shopper experience and brand performance:

1

Getting the basics right

Accurate product content is the starting point for everything that follows. When brands establish a single, accurate version of each product image and data, they eliminate the inconsistencies that confuse shoppers and undermine trust.

2

Giving shoppers the detail they need to make confident decisions

Today's shoppers expect more than just a product name and image. They want to see the product as if they were in store and they want to understand the attributes, benefits, ingredients and dimensions. Rich, well-structured content answers these questions before they've even asked, providing shoppers with a well-informed shopping experience.

3

Ensuring consistent content reaches every channel

A product only performs as well as the content that represents it. Seamless distribution across all channels ensures that what shoppers see in one place matches what they see everywhere else, reducing confusion and boosting confidence.

4

Learning from what's working – and what isn't

Shopper behavior evolves quickly. Search trends shift and retailer standards change. Continuous optimization helps brands stay aligned with what shoppers are actually looking for and how they interact with products online.

5

Minimizing shopper uncertainty

In an online world where shoppers can't pick up, compare or physically interact with products, rich media has become one of the most important tools for building shopper understanding and confidence. Images, videos, 360-degree views, comparison visuals and reviews do far more than make the PDP look good, it gives shoppers the reassurance they used to get on a physical shelf.

05

MAKING YOUR PRODUCTS UNDERSTANDABLE TO MACHINES AND DISCOVERABLE TO SHOPPERS

Unlike humans, an AI system does not experience a PDP design or brand storytelling first. They begin with data, the fields, attributes and signals that define a product such as:

- Structured attributes: size, ingredients, allergens, materials, dimensions, sustainability claims
- Clear product relationships: variants, multipacks, replacements, compatibility
- Normalized units and formats: measurements and taxonomies
- High quality media with context: alt text, captions, images

When these elements are complete, consistent and coherent, AI can classify, rank and recommend products far more accurately. When they are incomplete or inconsistent, products risk being excluded, reducing visibility when it matters most.

Good copy is readable. Good data is reliable. AI requires the latter.

Images and video already help humans decide. They can also help AI, if the media is described and organized correctly:

- Provide alt text and media labels that describe what the asset shows
- Maintain a logical image order – show primary hero image first and then show the key angles of the product
- Ensure text on pack is legible in at least one product image – if not use mobile optimized imagery to call out the key attributes
- Use consistent backgrounds and framing so models can extract shape, color and key visual cues more reliably

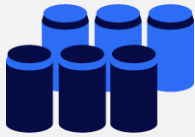
Common pitfalls that reduce AI discoverability include:

- Titles that read like keyword dumps
- Duplication or conflicting attributes across variants or retailers
- Unstructured “miscellaneous” fields that hold critical facts but never make it into the attributes
- Inconsistent units for example ml, mL or milliliters.

06

YOUR CHECKLIST: ARE YOU AI READY?

Content structure



- Titles need to follow a consistent pattern, for example brand + product + variant + size.
- Key attributes are complete and mapped to standard taxonomies.
- Units, casing and vocabulary are normalized across the range.

Clarity and disambiguation



- Parent / child relationships and variant logic are explicit.
- Deprecated SKUs, reformulations and rebrands are clearly linked to successors.
- Claims including vegan and gluten free are supported by attributes not just copy.

Media and metadata



- Primary and secondary images are high resolution and consistently framed.
- Alt text, captions and image purpose i.e. front, back and close up images are populated.
- Videos and 360 product views include concise summaries.

Governance



- Time sensitive information including price and promotion is segregated from evergreen data.

07

PREPARING FOR WHAT COMES NEXT

The commerce landscape will only continue to grow more complex. New channels will emerge. AI systems will become more influential. Retailer requirements will evolve. Shopper expectations will rise. Brands can no longer rely on reactive processes, isolated systems or partial fixes. The omni channel world demands clarity, consistency and adaptability at scale.

At the center of it all is product content. When that content is accurate, complete and connected, it acts as a stabilizing force across a fragmented ecosystem. When it isn't, even the strongest brands can become invisible.

Solving the omni challenge is not about mastering every channel individually. It is about creating the framework that allows products to perform everywhere, from retailer PDPs to social commerce feeds to AI powered search. It is about building confidence for shoppers and control for the brands. As well as recognizing the decisions being made behind the scenes, how the content is captured, structured, enriched and optimized.

The brands that will thrive in this evolving landscape are those that treat product content as a strategic asset, not as an operational afterthought. They will prioritize governance over guesswork, consistency over complexity and readiness over reaction. They will build systems, habits and disciplines that allow them to keep up with change, not chase it.

Ultimately, solving the omni challenge isn't just about responding to today's challenges. It is about investing into tomorrow's possibilities.

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About NIQ Brandbank

NIQ Brandbank is the leading provider of digital product content solutions powering omnichannel shopping experiences.

We enable brands and retailers to deliver the best shopping experience by giving them the ability to capture and share rich digital product content on all channels seamlessly. NIQ Brandbank's end-to-end solutions connect shoppers to the most up to date and relevant digital product content making consumer goods more discoverable and engaging.

The world's biggest brands including Walmart, Tesco, Carrefour, Asda Unilever, P&G and PepsiCo use NIQ Brandbank every day to digitalise the shopper experience.

With over 25 years of experience and operating in 39 countries, NIQ Brandbank is the content partner to over 52,000+ brands, 700+ retailers, and wholesalers across the globe, creating a rich online shopping experience, while minimising the cost and complexity for the industry.